

ANNIE (CHENXI) ZHOU

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EDUCATION

University of Wisconsin, Madison, WI, U.S. Curriculum and Instruction Ph.D. **Starting 09/2026**

- **Concentration:** Design, Informal, and Creative Education (DICE)
- **Advisors:** Dr. Matthew Berland

University of Michigan (U-M), Ann Arbor, MI, U.S. Educational Studies M.A. **08/2024 – 12/2025**

- **Concentration:** Design and Technologies for Learning Across Culture and Contexts
- **Advisors:** Dr. Chris Quintana and Dr. Rebecca Quintana
- **GPA:** 4.00 / 4.00

Tongji University, Shanghai, China | Design B.Eng. | Graduate with Honors **09/2016 – 07/2021**

- **Concentration:** Environmental Design
- **Exchange program:** Service Design at the University of Navarra
- **WES-evaluated GPA:** 4.00 / 4.00 (equivalent to 4.69/5.00, top 2%)

EDUCATION RESEARCH & PRACTICE

GRIP Lab, Marsal Family School of Education, U-M | Research Assistant **01/2025 – Present**

- **Syllabus Analysis:** Co-designed a coding scheme, led syllabus analysis, and conducted quantitative analyses to examine syllabus design variations and their relationships with students' learning gains.
- **Database Management:** Led the transfer, organization, and management of project data in a new database system.

Community Tech Consultants (CTC) Program, U-M | Curriculum Designer **03/2025 – Present**

- **Curriculum Development:** Led the full design cycle of a community-based curriculum preparing college students as culturally responsive tech consultants, including literature review, data collection and analysis, evaluation, and iterative refinement.
- **Data Analysis and Writing:** Led qualitative analysis of prior training data, mentored undergraduate researchers in the coding process, and led the writing of a conference paper based on the findings.

Eileen Lappin Weiser Center for the Learning Sciences, U-M | Research Fellow **05/2025 – Present**

- **Design-Based Research:** Conducted design-based research on the development of AI-produced instructor avatar videos to enhance learner engagement in online course discussions through iterative cycles of learner feedback analysis, design, testing, and refinement.
- **Scoping Review:** Led a scoping review and manuscript development on the use of generative AI instructor avatars in instructional videos.

Center for Academic Innovation, U-M | Learning Experience Designer 09/2024 – 04/2025

- **Course Development:** Supported syllabus planning and developed teaching and learning materials, such as slides, quizzes, and course summaries.
- **Course Deployment:** Supported the deployment and management of the online learning platform, helping ensure smooth course access, effective delivery, and an engaging learning experience.

Equitable Teaching Website, LSA, U-M | Digital Marketing Assistant 08/2024 – 05/2025

- **Culturally Responsive Teaching Research:** Conducted a systematic literature review and instructor interviews on culturally responsive teaching; wrote a blog post to inform inclusive teaching practices.
- **Outreach and Communications:** Managed the project website and created inclusive monthly newsletters to enhance accessibility, communication, and outreach.

ClassIn Educational Technology Co., Shanghai | Curriculum Designer 09/2023 – 02/2024

- **Curriculum Development:** Led the development of 10+ K–12 curricula implemented across schools in China, reaching over 1,850 students, with topics including AI, environmental education, and more.
- **Textbook Design:** Led the development of an upper-elementary environmental education textbook to cultivate students' environmental awareness through an experiential learning journey.

SCHOLARLY WRITING

Papers in Peer-reviewed Conference Proceedings

- **Zhou, A., Seefeldt, K., Hui, J., Bare, C., Sanifu, L., & Dillahunt, T. R. (2026).** A community-engaged curriculum design model for culturally responsive tech consulting. *Proceedings of the 20th International Conference of the Learning Sciences (ICLS 2026). Irvine, USA: International Society of the Learning Sciences.*
- **Quintana, R., Tan, Y., Quintana, C., Zhou, A., & Wu, J. (2026).** Mapping practitioner openness and hesitation toward GenAI integration in learning design. In *Advances in quantitative ethnography: 8th International Conference on Quantitative Ethnography, ICQE 2026, Hiroshima, Japan, November 9–13, 2026, proceedings.* Springer.

Conference Presentations (Unpublished, peer-reviewed papers)

- **Zhou, A. (2026, April).** *Student Self-Positioning and the Development of Mathematical Competencies.* Roundtable session accepted for presentation at the Annual Meeting of the American Educational Research Association (AERA).
- **Quintana, R. M. & Zhou, A. (2026, April).** *Using affordance analysis to strategize the integration of AI-generated instructor avatars within MOOCs.* Poster session accepted for presentation at the Annual Meeting of the American Educational Research Association (AERA).

Public Scholarship

- **Zhou, A.** (2025, June). Good teaching from a historical perspective: Culturally responsive teaching. *University of Michigan Library Student Stories Blog*. <https://blogs.lib.umich.edu/student-stories/good-teaching-historical-perspective-culturally-responsive-teaching>
- **Zhou, A.** (2025, February). Stories of culturally responsive teaching from frontline instructors. *Equitable Teaching Project, University of Michigan*. <https://sites.lsa.umich.edu/equitable-teaching/stories-of-culturally-responsive-teaching-from-frontline-instructors/>

PROFESSIONAL PRESENTATION

- Quintana, R. M. & **Zhou, A.** (2026, February). *Designing for Learner Engagement with Instructor Avatars in AI-Produced MOOC Videos* [Presentation]. AI Institute for Adult Learning and Online Education. <https://aialoe.org/webinar-ai-aloe-webinar-with-rebecca-quintana-and-annie-zhou-from-the-university-of-michigan/>
- Silver, N., **Zhou, A.**, & Kebede, A. (2025, May). Designing an equitable syllabus [Conference presentation]. Enriching Scholarship Conference, University of Michigan. [Virtual].

SERVICE TO THE PROFESSION

Peer Reviewer for Conferences

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| • American Educational Research Association (AERA) | 2026 |
| • Learning Sciences Graduate Student Conference (LSGSC) | 2026 |

Peer Reviewer for Journals

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| • Research in Learning Technology | 2026 |
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TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teach For China (TFC), Nanning | Mathematics Teacher **07/2021 – 07/2023**

- **Teaching:** Designed and gave math courses for 1-3rd graders, with class rankings remaining in the top 3 among 21 township schools.
- **Research:** Conducted research on the local learning ecosystem and studied how community resources can be leveraged to enhance learning and teaching.
- **Leadership:** Led the volunteer team in organizing diverse community activities to expand the impact of the TFC program, fostering stronger community involvement and outreach.

DESIGN & MANAGEMENT EXPERIENCE

BIGmind Innovative Service Organization, Shanghai | Designer Intern **08/2020 – 03/2021**

- **User Experience Design:** Led user experience research and design through focus group discussions, expert panels, and workshops to inform design decisions and ensure alignment with project goals.
- **Media Design:** Co-designed a company website and developed inclusive, user-centered digital materials for diverse audiences across multiple projects.

- UN-Habitat China, Beijing | Program Assistant Intern05/2020 – 02/2021
- Designed visual materials—including annual reports, posters, and social media content—and assisted in planning and implementing workshops and conferences.

- SKILLS
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- Tools:** Qualtrics, Microsoft suite, Google suite, Adobe suite, Figma
 - Qualitative research skills:** Design-Based Research, Survey Design, Portraiture Study, Ethnography
 - Quantitative research skills:** Cluster Analysis, Correlation Analysis

- AWARDS
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| Graduate School Fellowship, University of Wisconsin–Madison | 2026-2027 |
| Marsal Excellent Award, U-M \$11,166 per semester | 2024-2025 |
| U-M Library Student Mini-Grant, U-M \$750 | 2025 |
| Excellent Teaching Quality Award, Nanning Municipal Bureau of Education | 2021-2023 |
| Municipal Outstanding Program Teacher, TFC | 2021-2022 |
| National Scholarship, Ministry of Education of China ¥ 8,000 | 2018 |
| Tongji Scholarship of Excellence, Tongji University ¥ 3,000 | 2017 |

- CERTIFICATION
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| Community Engaged Course Design Workshop, University of Michigan | 2026 |
| Learning Experience Design, University of Michigan | 2025 |
| Generative AI: Fundamentals, Applications, and Challenges, Coursera | 2024 |
| AI-Powered Data Analysis: A Practical Introduction, Coursera | 2024 |
| How Science Turns Data Into Knowledge, Coursera | 2024 |
| Social Work Practice: Advocating Social Justice and Change, Coursera | 2024 |
| Teacher Qualification Certificate in Elementary School Mathematics, Ministry of Education China | 2023 |

- PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS
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- American Educational Research Association (AERA) Member of Advanced Technologies for Learning SIG, Instructional Technology SIG, Research in Mathematics Education SIG
 - International Society of the Learning Sciences (ISLS)